

Realtime Cabo Variant — Official Rulebook (Draft v1)

1. Objective

The objective of the game is to have the **lowest total card value** among all players.

Players must:

- memorize their own hidden cards
 - track card swaps and reveals
 - react quickly during Mine phases
 - strategically eliminate cards
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2. Number of Players

2 to 6 players

3. Card Values

Only the numeric value of the card matters.

Card	Value
King	0
Ace	1
2–10	Face value
Jack	11

Queen 12
n

Suit/symbol does not matter.

4. Power Cards

Certain cards activate special abilities when drawn from the deck.

Card	Power
6, 7	View one card
8, 9	View another player's card
10, 11	Swap cards between players

5. Initial Setup

Each player receives:

4 face-down cards

Cards are arranged in a fixed 2×2 grid:

[TL] [TR]
[BL] [BR]

Where:

- TL = Top Left
- TR = Top Right
- BL = Bottom Left
- BR = Bottom Right

Card positions are fixed and cannot be rearranged.

6. Initial Reveal Phase

At the start of the game:

- Each player may privately view ONLY their own:
 - Bottom Left (BL)
 - Bottom Right (BR)

Other players cannot see these cards.

Once finished memorizing:

- the player presses “Ready”
 - the viewed cards flip face down again
 - those cards cannot be viewed again unless revealed by a power or effect
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7. Core Hidden Information Rules

All cards remain face down throughout the game.

Players must rely on:

- memory
- deduction
- tracking swaps and reveals

There is NO permanent public board state.

8. Turn Structure

Each turn proceeds in the following order:

1. Draw Phase
2. Action Phase

3. Discard Phase
 4. Mine Phase
 5. Turn End
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9. Draw Phase

The current player draws:

1 face-down card from the deck

The player may privately view this drawn card.

10. Action Phase

After viewing the drawn card, the player must choose ONE of the following actions:

Option A — Swap

The player may:

- exchange the drawn card with one of their own face-down cards

The replaced card becomes:

the open discard card

The newly acquired card is placed face down in the same position.

Option B — Use Power

If the drawn card is:

- 6
- 7
- 8
- 9
- 10
- 11

the player may use its power ability.

After using the power:

- the drawn card is discarded face up
 - powers cannot be reused from discarded cards
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Option C — Discard

The player may discard the drawn card face up without swapping.

11. Power Abilities

6 / 7 — Self View

The player may privately view:

ANY one face-down card

This may include:

- their own card
- an already known card
- an unknown card

The viewed card is shown only temporarily to that player.

8 / 9 — Opponent View

The player may privately view:

ONE face-down card belonging to another player

Only the viewing player sees the card.

10 / 11 — Swap Ability

The player may swap:

ONE card from any player
with
ONE card from any player

This includes:

- themselves
- two other players
- any combination

Rules:

- swapped cards remain face down
 - card positions remain fixed
 - players do not automatically see swapped cards
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12. Discard Phase

After the current player finishes their action:

A single face-up discard card exists on the table.

This card may trigger:

Mine Phase

13. Mine Phase

After a discard appears:

all players EXCEPT the current turn player may attempt to call:

Mine!

14. Mine Timing Rule

The first valid Mine input wins.

For online play:

- server determines winner based on earliest valid received input

Recommended Mine reaction window:

2 seconds

If no player calls Mine:

- turn ends immediately
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15. Mine Actions

The player who wins Mine must choose ONE of the following:

Option A — Exchange

The player may:

- swap the open discard card with
- one of their own face-down cards

The replaced card becomes the NEW discard card.

A new Mine phase immediately begins.

Option B — Elimination

The player may attempt to eliminate cards.

There are TWO elimination types.

16. Self Elimination

The player attempts elimination using one of THEIR OWN cards.

Procedure:

1. Player selects one of their face-down cards
2. The selected card is publicly revealed
3. If its value matches the discard card:
 - both cards are permanently removed
4. If incorrect:
 - elimination fails
 - player draws one penalty card from deck face down

All players see the revealed card.

17. Opponent Elimination

The player attempts elimination using another player's hidden card.

Procedure:

1. Player targets:
 - another player
 - one card position
2. Server secretly checks the targeted card
3. If value matches discard:
 - both cards are removed
4. If incorrect:
 - elimination fails
 - player receives one penalty card face down

The targeted hidden card is NOT publicly revealed.

Only the server verifies the result.

18. Mine Chain Rules

If a player chooses:

Exchange

then:

- a new discard card appears
- another Mine phase immediately begins

If a player chooses:

Elimination

then:

- subsequent Mine actions in that chain may ONLY perform eliminations
- exchanges are no longer allowed during that Mine chain

The Mine chain ends when:

- no player calls Mine within the Mine timer
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19. Card Removal Rules

Removed cards:

- permanently leave the game
- are not replaced

Players may therefore end the game with:

- 4 cards
 - 3 cards
 - 2 cards
 - 1 card
 - or even 0 cards
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20. Cabo Call

A player may call:

Cabo!

when they believe they have the lowest total value.

Recommended rule:

- Cabo may only be called at the START of the player's turn before drawing.
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21. Cabo Resolution

After Cabo is called:

- all players reveal all remaining cards
 - scores are calculated
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22. Successful Cabo

If the Cabo caller has:

the lowest total value

then:

Cabo caller receives:

0 points

-

all other players receive:

sum of their remaining cards

-

23. Failed Cabo

If another player has a lower value:

Cabo caller receives:

50 penalty points

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Player with actual lowest score receives:

0 points

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All others receive:

sum of remaining cards

-

24. Match Structure

Recommended:

- multiple rounds
- cumulative scoring

Suggested ending condition:

First player to reach 100 total points loses.
Lowest cumulative score wins.

25. Information Rules

Public Information

Publicly visible:

- discard cards
 - self-elimination reveals
 - successful removals
 - Mine winners
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Private Information

Hidden:

- face-down cards
 - deck order
 - failed opponent elimination targets
 - viewed power cards
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26. Online Server Rules

For online play:

The server is the ONLY source of truth.

The server controls:

- deck order
- hidden cards
- Mine timing
- elimination validation
- scoring

Clients never control game outcomes.

27. Core Gameplay Skills

The game rewards:

- memory
 - deduction
 - reaction speed
 - bluffing
 - tracking swaps
 - risk management
 - information control
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28. Recommended Online UX Features

Recommended features:

- fixed card positions
 - temporary reveal animations
 - Mine countdown timer
 - reaction effects
 - reconnect support
 - latency compensation
 - server-authoritative timing
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29. Recommended Internal Position Labels

For implementation:

Label	Position
TL	Top Left
TR	Top Right
BL	Bottom Left
BR	Bottom Right

These labels should be used internally by the server and client.

30. Game Identity

This game is fundamentally:

A realtime hidden-information memory and deduction game with card-based interaction mechanics.